THE GOLDEN CROSS STUDY

Every golden cross and every death cross on Bitcoin since 2012, graded at one, three and six months against a random day, with the falls that followed each one measured on intraday lows.

The lag nobody mentions, the whipsaws, the four crosses that printed after real bottoms, and the September 2026 cross with a dated ladder.

Bitcoin daily closes, 50 and 200 day averages. The cross printed Sep 8 at $78,449, 69 days after the July

62%
median gain already banked by the time a cross prints

5 of 11
golden crosses that fell 20%+ within 6 months

-22%
median fall after the first cross following a real bottom

Educational, not financial advice. The rule is stated before the numbers, the base rate sits next to every figure, and the sample sizes are printed rather than hidden. Twelve crosses is twelve crosses.

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THE DEFINITION

WHAT A GOLDEN CROSS IS, AND HOW IT WAS GRADED

The 50-day average is the mean of the last 50 daily closes. The 200-day average is the mean of the last 200. A golden cross is the day the 50 closes above the 200. A death cross is the day it closes below. That is the whole signal. It says the last two months have been higher than the last seven, and by construction it can only say so after the fact.

How each cross was graded. Bitstamp daily closes, so the cross date and price are the actual close the signal printed at. Forward return at 30, 90 and 180 days, close to close, compared with the same horizon measured from every day in the data set, the base rate. The worst fall within 180 days is the cross-day close to the lowest intraday low, wicks, per house rule. A whipsaw is the opposite cross within 90 days. The lag is the days since the lowest close of the prior 200 days and how far price had already risen from it.

The regime tag. A cross is marked bear if it printed inside one of the structural bear markets, December 2013 to January 2015, December 2017 to December 2018, November 2021 to November 2022, and the current one from the October 2025 top. The 2012 cross is taken from the longer Coin Metrics series because Bitstamp's 200-day average only exists from March 2012.

CLOSES IN, WICKS OUT

The signal is defined on closes, so the entry is a close. The pain is measured on wicks, because that is what a holder actually sat through.

THE FULL RECORD

ALL 12 GOLDEN CROSSES

CROSS	PRICE	30 DAYS	90 DAYS	180 DAYS	WORST FALL, 180D	FLIPPED BACK IN 90D	REGIME
12 Jul 2014	$638	-10%	-43%	-57%	-60%	yes	bear
15 Jul 2015	$286	-7%	-13%	+57%	-31%	yes	
28 Oct 2015	$306	+17%	+28%	+51%	-4%		
23 Apr 2019	$5,531	+42%	+87%	+49%	-10%		
18 Feb 2020	$10,185	-39%	-5%	+17%	-62%	yes	
21 May 2020	$9,062	+3%	+30%	+95%	-5%		
15 Sep 2021	$48,151	+28%	+0%	-18%	-32%		
07 Feb 2023	$23,252	-12%	+19%	+25%	-16%		
30 Oct 2023	$34,495	+10%	+22%	+84%	-1%		
28 Oct 2024	$69,918	+37%	+47%	+35%	-4%		
22 May 2025	$111,743	-9%	+2%	-17%	-20%		
08 Sep 2026	$78,449				-3%		bear

Returns close to close. Worst fall on intraday lows. The September 2026 cross has no forward history yet.

Eleven crosses with history. Thirty days later the median was +3%, the same as any random month. Ninety days later, +19% against +10% for any random 90 days. One hundred and eighty days later, +35% against +33%. Over a month, nothing. Over three months, an edge. Over six, back to normal. And the cost of holding: five of eleven fell 20% or more within six months, the median worst dip was 16%, and three flipped back to a death cross within 90 days.

THE MIRROR IMAGE

ALL 12 DEATH CROSSES

CROSS	PRICE	30 DAYS	90 DAYS	180 DAYS	WORST FALL, 180D	FLIPPED BACK IN 90D	REGIME
09 Apr 2014	$442	+2%	+41%	-26%	-38%		bear
04 Sep 2014	$487	-33%	-23%	-42%	-69%		bear
15 Sep 2015	$230	+11%	+93%	+80%	-3%	yes	
31 Mar 2018	$6,929	+33%	-10%	-4%	-17%		bear
26 Oct 2019	$9,253	-23%	-9%	-19%	-58%		
25 Mar 2020	$6,692	+12%	+44%	+56%	-12%	yes	
19 Jun 2021	$35,507	-13%	+33%	+34%	-19%	yes	
14 Jan 2022	$43,102	-2%	-7%	-53%	-59%		bear
12 Sep 2023	$25,844	+4%	+60%	+167%	-3%	yes	
10 Aug 2024	$60,952	-6%	+26%	+58%	-14%	yes	
07 Apr 2025	$79,127	+23%	+38%	+55%	-6%	yes	
16 Nov 2025	$94,187	-7%	-26%	-16%	-36%		bear

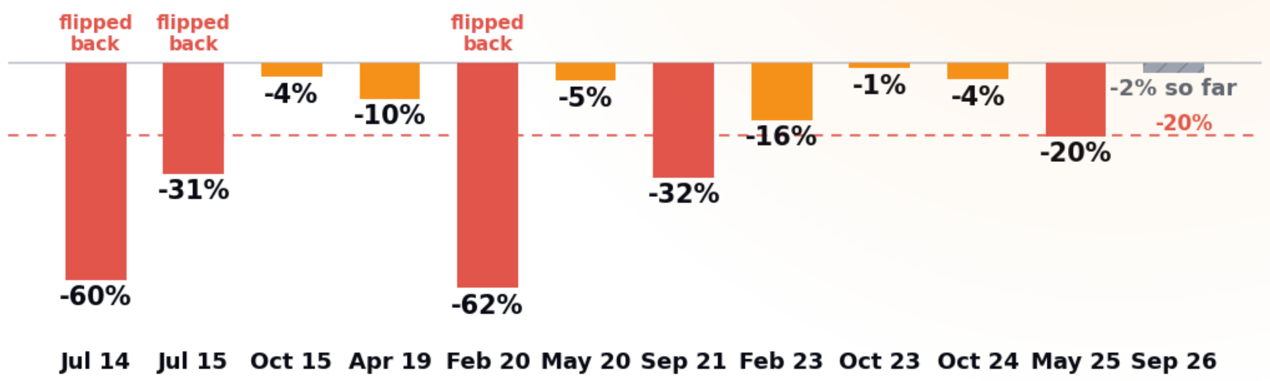
Same grading, same base rates. Bear tag as above.

Here is the twist. Outside bear markets, the last seven death crosses, the supposed sell signal, were followed by a median gain of 56% over six months, six of seven higher. In a bull market a death cross tends to print near a low, because the 50-day average has to fall for weeks to get under the 200, and by then the dip is old. In a bear market the same cross printed near the start of the damage, 2014, 2018, 2022 and November 2025. The regime did the work. The cross took the credit either way.

THE LAG

IT SHOWS UP LATE

Across the eleven golden crosses with history, the cross printed a median 78 days after the swing low, with price already up a median 62% from it. The signal cannot do otherwise. A 50-day average needs weeks of higher prices before it can catch a 200-day average. The 2026 cross printed 69 days after the July 1 low with price up 36% from the $57,735 wick.



worst fall from each golden cross within 6 months, intraday lows. 5 of 11 fell 20%+. 3 flipped back within

The chart is the part the buy-signal crowd skips. Five of eleven crosses were followed by a 20% or worse fall within six months, and three of those eleven flipped straight back to a death cross. The 2020 cross fell 62% into the March crash within a month of printing. The 2014 cross, the only one to print inside a bear market, fell 43% in 90 days and 57% in six months, and flipped back within weeks. One case is one case. It is also the only prior cross that printed below a bear's last lower high, which is where the 2026 cross sits.

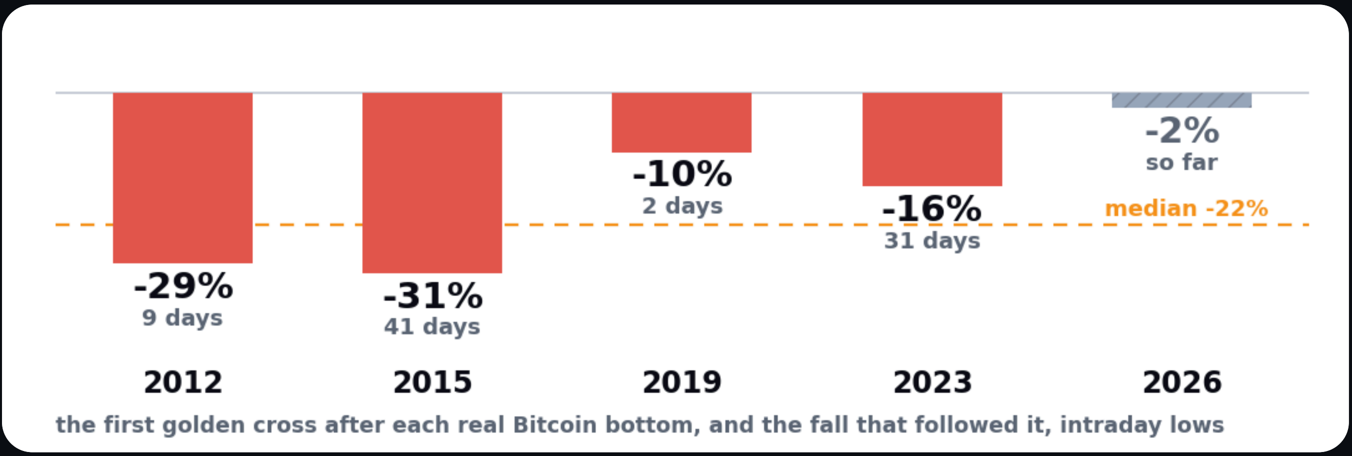
EVEN IF THE BOTTOM IS IN

THE FIRST CROSS AFTER EVERY REAL BOTTOM

Suppose the bulls are right and July 1, 2026 was the bottom. The fair test is then not every cross, but the first golden cross after each real bottom, 2011, 2015, 2018 and 2022, and what happened next.

BOTTOM	FIRST GOLDEN CROSS	PRICE	LAG, GAIN BANKED	FALL AFTER THE CROSS	30 DAYS	180 DAYS
Nov 2011	9 Feb 2012	$6	83 days, +159%	-29% in 9 days	-17%	+88%
Jan 2015	15 Jul 2015	$286	182 days, +88%	-31% in 41 days, flipped back	-7%	+57%
Dec 2018	23 Apr 2019	$5,531	129 days, +77%	-10% in 2 days	+42%	+49%
Nov 2022	7 Feb 2023	$23,252	78 days, +50%	-16% in 31 days	-12%	+25%
Jul 2026, if it is the bottom	8 Sep 2026	$78,449	69 days, +36%	-2.5% so far		

Falls from the cross-day close to the lowest intraday low within 180 days. Bitstamp closes; the 2012 cross from the Coin Metrics series.



It fell every time. The median fall was 22%, three of the four were lower a month later, and one flipped back to a death cross. Then all four were higher six months later. The honest reading is that after a real bottom the golden cross marked the start of the next dip, not the end of it, and the buyer who waited for that dip got the same recovery at a better price.

THE LIVE CASE

SEPTEMBER 8, 2026, DATED

The cross printed on the September 8 close at **$78,449**, with the 50-day average at $70,401 and the 200-day at $69,965, six tenths of a percent apart. It came 69 days after the July low with price up 36%, inside the lag range of every prior cross. It printed below the bear's last lower high at $82,833, which is the structural definition this page has used all year, and which only the 2014 cross shares.

CASE APPLIED TO $78,449	FALL	LANDS AT
mildest real case (2019)	-10%	$70,600
median of the four	-22%	$60,800
2015 case	-31%	$54,100, below the July low

The four post-bottom falls applied to the 2026 cross price.

Two different studies now point at the same zone. The real-recovery pullback study published on September 4 put the range at $64,200, $59,250 and $56,800 off the rally top. The post-bottom golden crosses put it at $70,600, $60,800 and $54,100 off the cross. Different measurement, same neighbourhood.

THE TEST

This is a study, not a call. The test for the bear case is unchanged. A daily and weekly close above $82,833 ends the structure and everything gets re-evaluated in public.

THE HONEST LIMITS

WHAT THIS STUDY DOES NOT SAY

It does not say the golden cross is useless. At 90 days it beat a random day, +19% against +10%, and every post-bottom cross was higher six months later. It says the signal is late by construction and that the dip after it was the rule, not the exception. Used as a trend label rather than an entry, it is fine.

Twelve crosses is twelve crosses. Four post-bottom cases. One bear-market case. Medians on samples this size describe the middle of a wide spread. Every figure carries its count for that reason.

Daily closes, one exchange. Simple averages, no exponential variants, Bitstamp only. A different average or a different venue moves the cross by a day or two and the returns by a little. The 2012 cross uses the Coin Metrics series because no exchange series with a 200-day history exists that early.

Data pinned 11 September 2026. Bitstamp BTC/USD daily to 10 September 2026. Scripts: GoldenCross/gc_study.py, gc_charts.py. This is education, not financial advice.

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